

New arrivals

Viewsonic launches PC mini series with many digital entertainment features

Competition growing

Orkut now has a new face; although it feels like a copy of Facebook

Cooler Master Silent Pro M600

Silently efficient

One of the key features of this power supply is an 80 PLUS certified one which is an industry rating for PSUs. The Silent Pro PSU has a similar quality as the Corsair HX series of power supplies. It's a modular power supply with the primary power cables sheathed. The others can be plugged as per your needs. This for one means less clutter in your cabinet. The PSU has a large 135-mm fan that blows towards the inside of the cabinet. The PSU is quiet, except for a very faint clicking sound that can be heard if you're right next to the fan. Rubber frames are provided to cut down vibrations transferred from the PSU to the body. All these qualities

make it a good candidate for a performance HTPC.

Performance is flawless - it can easily run graphics in SLI and CrossFire configuration. Plugging in SATA power connectors after connecting the SATA cables was slightly difficult. We had to unplug them and force the power cables in place. This happened with two different hard drives we set up for this rig.

The price is decent, although we'd love if it was priced around Rs. 6,000. The power rating of 600W is overkill for someone building a mid-ranged gaming system for approximately Rs. 30,000. For a system that isn't run all day and night, the power efficiency certification might be just a novelty. Still, we feel anyone spending over Rs. 50,000 on a system must buy something of this calibre.

Contact

Cooler Master

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Web: www.cooler-master.com

Price: Rs. 7,000

Specifications

600 W output, modular design, 2 PCIe (8-pin), 4 floppy pins, 9 SATA power

Dimensions: 150 x 86 x 150 mm



RATINGS

Features.....	7.5
Performance	8
Build quality	8
Value for money ...	6.5
Overall	7.5

Photographs: Jiten Gandhi

Contact

Philips Electronics India Ltd.

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Web: www.india.philips.com

Price: Rs. 24,990

Specifications

Media: DVD-R/-RW, Video CD, USB; **Connectors:** HDMI, Component, Composite, Digital optical/coaxial out, 7.1 Analog connects; 12 bit / 150 MHz Video DAC; **Dimensions:** 245 x 55.7 x 435 mm

RATINGS

Features.....	7
Performance	7
Build Quality	6.5
Value	6
Overall	7

Philips BDP7500

Feature rich beauty

The player is indeed a beauty. Brushed aluminum body and a mirror finish on front panel will make it look good as a part of any home theater setup. It's got that retro LED display coupled with three touch buttons for eject, play and pause. Power on the player and it's visual appeal goes up a notch (if that's possible) thanks to the soft blue glow it emanates underneath. It has a USB input on the front panel covered with a nice snap on slider so good dust protection there. On the back panel we find a component, composite and HDMI output. There's even

support for directly connecting a 7.1 channel speaker system. The HDMI cable supplied with the player was of very high quality.

In terms of performance we found the DVD playback to be top-notch. In terms of Blu-ray quality, the colours appear slightly washed out and the film grain is more pronounced. Nothing that some tweaking with picture settings on the player and TV can't solve. The player's settings interface as well as the data navigation interface is

very intuitive. It supports XviD and can play MP3 or picture files off the USB with ease. The upscaling is the best we've seen. However the remote has clackity navigation buttons that are just plain painful to use. Overall a good blu-ray player and an excellent feature rich media player.

The Philips BDP7500 is costlier than Sony's BDP-360, but overall, it's also better. However, it would be easier to recommend if it were priced lower than the current tag of Rs. 24,990.

